



"You decoded my cipher? Et tu Brutus?"

to communicate secretly. The Caesar Cipher has a letter shifted two places further in the alphabetical order. T shifts to V and Y moves over to A, to give an idea. Given below is the Caesar's code which was perhaps the first ever cipher to be used by children.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

CDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZAB

This is an example of a mono-alphabetic substitution cipher where each alphabet is assigned to another.

However, it was Leon Battista Alberti who laid the cornerstone to most modern cryptography. Also known as the Father of Western Cryptography, he is credited with the invention of the polyalphabetic substitution, also known as the Alberti cipher, which came about before Caesar's cipher. This technique enables different ciphertext symbols to portray the same plaintext symbol. A closer inspection reveals that this simple substitution makes it all the more difficult to interpret the code, especially using the method of frequency analysis.

Ingenuisly, Alberti designed this cipher after decoding others and understanding their vulnerabilities. This unique cipher was designed with two copper disks, fitting into each other. The disks have alphabets inscribed on them. A coded message can be sent by aligning a prearranged letter on the inner disk with the corresponding alphabet on the outer disk, which makes